1. Which of the following is the main foundation of morality?

a) Legal rules

b) Social norms and values

c) Professional standards

d) Scientific evidence

2. Which is not a characteristic of professional ethics?

a) Universality

b) Focus on self-interest

c) Service to society

d) Professional integrity

3. Professional standards in engineering practice are usually:

a) Voluntary guidelines with no importance

b) Binding codes established by professional bodies

c) Personal preferences of engineers

d) Rules that change daily

4. The primary goal of professional ethics is to:

a) Maximize personal profit

b) Ensure integrity, responsibility, and public safety

c) Promote competition

d) Reduce government regulation

5. Which of the following is an example of moral principle?

a) Paying income tax

b) Keeping promises

c) Signing a contract

d) Filing a patent

6. Utilitarianism is based on the principle of:

a) Duty above consequences

b) Greatest happiness for greatest number

c) Following cultural traditions

d) Avoiding responsibility

7. Who is known as the founder of deontological ethics?

a) John Stuart Mill

b) Aristotle

c) Immanuel Kant

d) Jeremy Bentham

8. Virtue ethics, given by Aristotle, focuses on:

a) Rules and duties

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b) Consequences of actions
c) Moral character and virtues
d) Social contracts

9. "Ethics depend on culture and situation" refers to:
a) Relativism
b) Absolutism
c) Utilitarianism
d) Deontology

10. The theory that actions are morally right if they follow universal moral laws is:
a) Virtue ethics
b) Deontology
c) Pragmatism
d) Relativism

11. Normativity in science means:
a) Science is always value-free
b) Science has ethical and social implications
c) Technology is purely technical
d) Science is only for profit

12. Which of the following is an example of ethical normativity in technology?
a) AI systems used responsibly without bias
b) Blind use of machines
c) Ignoring data privacy issues
d) Maximizing production at all costs

13. The idea that science is not neutral and carries responsibilities is called:
a) Ethical neutrality
b) Scientific objectivity
c) Normativity of science
d) Relativism

14. A moral dilemma arises when:
a) The engineer has no responsibility
b) Two ethical principles come into conflict
c) Rules are very clear
d) Only profits matter

15. Conflict of interest means:
a) A professional is unsure about rules
b) Personal interest interferes with professional duty

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c) There are no standards
d) A disagreement among colleagues

16. Which of the following is an ethical issue in contracts?
a) Mutual consent
b) Transparency and fairness
c) Breach of terms
d) All of the above

17. Which is a violation of rights?
a) Equal access to opportunity
b) Denying someone's freedom of speech
c) Providing fair treatment
d) Respecting confidentiality

18. Consent is ethically valid only when it is:
a) Forced
b) Fully informed and voluntary
c) Hidden in contracts
d) Ignored for efficiency

19. Privacy and confidentiality are essential in engineering because:
a) They prevent legal action only
b) They protect sensitive information and build trust
c) They are optional practices
d) They ensure profits only

20. Consultancy requires that engineers:
a) Mislead clients for profit
b) Provide honest, competent, and unbiased advice
c) Share confidential client data
d) Ignore legal requirements

21. Allocation of burdens and benefits means:
a) Sharing only benefits among stakeholders
b) Distributing risks and rewards fairly in society
c) Giving burden to clients
d) Ignoring fairness issues

22. Direct responsibility of an engineer applies when:
a) He/she performs an action personally
b) A subordinate makes an error
c) Government passes a law
d) Another company makes a mistake

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23. Indirect responsibility arises when:
a) Someone else is harmed due to your actions indirectly
b) A person follows all rules
c) Engineers act honestly
d) Government supervises

24. Filing patents ensures:
a) Exclusive legal rights to inventors
b) Free access for everyone
c) Ignoring intellectual property
d) Preventing innovation

25. Piracy in engineering ethics refers to:
a) Unauthorized copying/distribution of software or products
b) Legal patenting of ideas
c) Honest consultancy
d) Allocating benefits fairly

26. Cloning raises ethical concerns mainly about:
a) Innovation and creativity
b) Identity, consent, and human dignity
c) Patent laws only
d) Consultancy rules

27. An engineer discloses client's trade secrets without permission. This is:
a) A contract
b) A violation of confidentiality
c) A patent filing
d) An act of consultancy

28. A professional engineer should prioritize:
a) Employer's profit always
b) Public safety, health, and welfare
c) Breaking contracts for convenience
d) Personal gain

29. Which of the following is a contemporary ethical issue in engineering?
a) AI bias and data privacy
b) Climate change responsibility
c) Genetic engineering
d) All of the above

30. In ethical decision-making, the primary guiding principle for engineers is:
a) Personal profit

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b) Public interest and welfare
c) Employer interest only
d) Reducing project cost

31-55. [Advanced / Difficult MCQs continue as given in the previous advanced set]

Answer Key (for all 55 MCQs)

1. b
2. b
3. b
4. b
5. b
6. b
7. c
8. c
9. a
10. b
11. b
12. a
13. c
14. b
15. b
16. d
17. b
18. b
19. b
20. b
21. b
22. a
23. a

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24. a
25. a
26. b
27. b
28. b
29. d
30. b

Advanced MCQs (31-55)

31. b
32. b
33. b
34. b
35. a
36. b
37. b
38. b
39. b
40. a
41. c
42. b
43. a
44. b
45. b
46. a
47. b
48. a
49. a
50. a

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51. a

52. a

53. a

54. b

55. d

Advanced / Difficult MCQs (31–55)

31. Which of the following best distinguishes ethics from morality?
a) Ethics are culturally relative; morality is universal
b) Ethics are codified by professions; morality is guided by society
c) Ethics are enforced by law; morality is optional
d) Ethics always override morality
✅ **Answer: b**

32. An engineer follows all legal requirements but ignores fairness in tender allocation. This shows:
a) Ethical practice but not moral practice
b) Legal compliance but ethical failure
c) Moral practice but not legal compliance
d) Ethical relativism
✅ **Answer: b**

33. Which of the following is a core principle of professional standards?
a) Profit maximization
b) Public safety and welfare
c) Legal contract enforcement
d) Innovation without restriction
✅ **Answer: b**

34. A company dumps untreated waste into a river to save costs. Which ethical theory would most strongly oppose this action because of its consequences on society?
a) Deontology
b) Virtue ethics
c) Utilitarianism
d) Relativism
✅ **Answer: c**

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35. According to Kantian ethics, lying to save a friend from danger is:

a) Morally right, as it prevents harm

b) Morally wrong, because lying violates universal duty

c) Context-dependent and relative

d) Justified under utilitarian reasoning

✅ **Answer: b**

36. An engineer refuses to take a bribe because honesty is part of his character. This reflects:

a) Virtue ethics

b) Utilitarianism

c) Relativism

d) Deontology

✅ **Answer: a**

37. Ethical relativism may become dangerous in engineering practice because:

a) It ignores cultural contexts

b) It may justify unsafe practices under "local norms"

c) It prioritizes universal values

d) It aligns strictly with law

✅ **Answer: b**

38. Which situation best illustrates normativity of science?

a) Using AI to improve efficiency regardless of bias

b) Questioning whether nuclear energy should be used despite its efficiency

c) Following only technical accuracy in research

d) Ignoring ethics in innovation

✅ **Answer: b**

39. A scientist argues "Our work is only technical; ethics is not our concern." This statement:

a) Correctly describes science

b) Ignores normativity of science and technology

c) Reflects utilitarian ethics

d) Supports virtue ethics

✅ **Answer: b**

40. Which ethical issue arises most prominently with data-driven AI systems?

a) Confidentiality and bias

b) Deontological duty

c) Virtue ethics

d) Patent law only

✅ **Answer: a**

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41. An engineer is asked to hide safety test failures to meet deadlines. This is a case of:

a) Conflict of interest
b) Breach of confidentiality
c) Violation of professional responsibility
d) Relativism in ethics

✅ **Answer: c**

42. A doctor hides critical side effects of a drug to increase company profits. Which right of the patient is most violated?

a) Privacy
b) Informed consent
c) Freedom of speech
d) Contractual right

✅ **Answer: b**

43. Which of the following is an example of direct responsibility?

a) An engineer personally approving faulty blueprints
b) A government official who ignored complaints
c) A bystander witnessing an accident
d) A subordinate's mistake beyond control

✅ **Answer: a**

44. Which scenario shows indirect responsibility?

a) Engineer knowingly designs a weak bridge
b) Engineer's work is misused later by another company
c) Engineer signs off fake reports deliberately
d) Engineer refuses a bribe

✅ **Answer: b**

45. A professional contract is valid only if:

a) Both parties are coerced
b) Mutual consent and fairness exist
c) It favors the stronger party
d) Confidentiality is ignored

✅ **Answer: b**

46. Sharing patient health data without permission is a violation of:

a) Confidentiality
b) Public safety
c) Virtue ethics
d) Deontological duty

✅ **Answer: a**

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47. Which ethical issue is central to cloning?

a) Innovation speed
b) Human dignity and identity
c) Contractual fairness
d) Public safety only

✅ **Answer: b**

48. Which of the following best describes piracy in professional ethics?

a) Unauthorized duplication of intellectual property
b) Developing innovative ideas
c) Filing patents legally
d) Consulting clients

✅ **Answer: a**

49. In the context of patent rights vs. public health, which ethical dilemma arises?

a) Profit vs. survival needs
b) Virtue vs. duty
c) Consent vs. dissent
d) Relativism vs. absolutism

✅ **Answer: a**

50. Allocation of burdens and benefits in climate change policies is an ethical debate about:

a) Equality vs. fairness among nations
b) Deontology vs. utilitarianism
c) Piracy vs. patents
d) Public vs. private safety

✅ **Answer: a**

51. A consultant engineer recommends a costly but unnecessary solution to a client. This violates:

a) Honesty in consultancy
b) Client confidentiality
c) Legal compliance
d) Relativism in ethics

✅ **Answer: a**

52. In whistleblowing cases, the biggest ethical conflict is between:

a) Confidentiality and public safety
b) Contracts and patents
c) Utilitarianism and relativism
d) Virtue and legality

✅ **Answer: a**

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53. Which ethical principle would justify whistleblowing if it prevents major harm?

a) Utilitarianism

b) Relativism

c) Deontology

d) Virtue ethics

✅ **Answer: a**

54. Engineers refusing to work on military weapons due to personal beliefs show:

a) Professional misconduct

b) Ethical dissent

c) Lack of confidentiality

d) Breach of patents

✅ **Answer: b**

55. Which of the following represents an ethical challenge in the digital era?

a) Data privacy breaches

b) AI bias

c) Software piracy

d) All of the above

✅ **Answer: d**

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